

# REVERSE DRURY CONVENTION

## ABOUT THE DEALS

You will always be in the South position. Either you or partner may open the bidding.

## ABOUT REVERSE DRURY

Does your partnership open "light" in third seat?

If you do not do so now, and do not intend to start, then you can just skip to some other lesson - Reverse Drury is only for those light-opening partnerships.

That said, suppose you have passed with this hand:

♠ K 10 8 5   ♥ Q 9 3   ♦ A Q 3   ♣ 9 6 2

and you hear partner open 1♠ in third seat.

If you knew partner had a full-blown opening hand you would jump to 3♠ as a limit raise. But what if partner has made a light, third-hand opening with:

♠ A Q 9 7 3   ♥ 10 2   ♦ K J 8   ♣ 8 4 3

As you see, 3♠ is too high.

### Drury 2♣:

Douglas Drury came up with the idea to use a 2♣ bid to allow the passed hand to ask whether the third-hand opening of a Major suit was sound or was light.

**LHO   Pard   RHO   You**

pass

pass   1♥/1♠   pass   2♣

The 2♣ bid is completely artificial, and asks Opener to further describe his hand.

| OPENER REBIDS AFTER REVERSE DRURY 2♣ |                                        |
|--------------------------------------|----------------------------------------|
| return to 2 of the Major             | light opening                          |
| 2♦                                   | sound opening                          |
| jump to 4 of the Major               | sign-off, no slam interest             |
| anything else                        | sound opening, descriptive and forcing |

By the way, the reason for REVERSE in the convention name is that in the original Drury the meanings of the "return to 2 of the Major" and "2♦" bid were switched. Some people still play the original format, but more have gone to the meanings shown here and called it Reverse Drury.

### Later bidding:

Basically the passed hand has already described his limit-raise hand pretty well with the 2♣ bid. Some partnerships build on this by having his next bid indicate whether he holds 3 trumps or 4 but this is not a universally agreed upon method.

More often, Opener just takes control of the auction after his rebid.

Since the passed hand will always use Drury 2♣ when holding 10+ points with support for the Major suit, that means that a jump to 3 of the Major is preemptive, showing LESS than 10 points and at least 4 trumps.

### The price for using Reverse Drury:

Consider this bidding:

| LHO  | Pard | RHO  | You |
|------|------|------|-----|
|      |      | pass |     |
| pass | 1♠   | pass | ??  |

And you holding this hand:

♠ 6 5   ♥ 10 2   ♦ J 10 3   ♣ A K J 8 4 3

Don't get carried away and bid 2♣, that meaning no longer exists in your arsenal. Instead you would have to bid either 2NT or 3♣.

The 8 Practice Deals can be considered the equivalent of 8000 more words.

Board: 1  
Dealer: **South**  
Contract: 2♥  
Declarer: North  
Lead: ♠7

Board: 2  
Dealer: **West**  
Contract: 2♠  
Declarer: East  
Lead: ♦2

Board: 3  
Dealer: **North**  
Contract: 4♠  
Declarer: South  
Lead: ♣K

Board: 4  
Dealer: **East**  
Contract: 4♥  
Declarer: West  
Lead: ♥2

Board: 5  
Dealer: **South**  
Contract: 3♥  
Declarer: North  
Lead: ♥10

Board: 6  
Dealer: **West**  
Contract: 4♠  
Declarer: East  
Lead: ♥2

**Board 1**

South Deals  
None Vul

♠ Q J 10 6  
♥ 9 2  
♦ J 9 8  
♣ K Q 7 2

♠ K 4 3  
♥ A Q J 5 4  
♦ 6 3  
♣ 10 9 5



♠ 9 8 7 2  
♥ 7 6  
♦ A Q 10 4  
♣ A J 6

♠ A 5  
♥ K 10 8 3  
♦ K 7 5 2  
♣ 8 4 3

| <i>West</i> | <i>North</i> | <i>East</i> | <i>South</i> |
|-------------|--------------|-------------|--------------|
|             |              |             | Pass         |
| Pass        | 1♥           | Pass        | 2♣           |
| Pass        | 2♥           |             |              |
| All Pass    |              |             |              |
| 2♥ by North |              |             |              |
| Lead: ♠7    |              |             |              |

With 11 points in support of ♥s you would generally make a limit raise with this hand. But since partner is in third seat you need to go carefully in case he has opened light. So you bid a Reverse Drury 2♣.

Partner rebids 2♥. What do you say next?

Partner's 2♥ rebid tells you that he opened light. So you pass.

**Board 2**

West Deals

N-S Vul

♠ Q 8 7 4

♥ A 5 3

♦ K Q 3

♣ 10 8 2

♠ 6 3

♥ 10 7 6 2

♦ A 10 8

♣ K Q 7 4

|   |   |   |
|---|---|---|
|   | N |   |
| W |   | E |
|   | S |   |

♠ A K J 9 5

♥ Q 9 4

♦ 7 6

♣ 9 6 5

♠ 10 2

♥ K J 8

♦ J 9 5 4 2

♣ A J 3

*West*

Pass

2 ♣

All Pass

2 ♠ by East

Lead: ♦ 2

*North*

Pass

Pass

*East*

1 ♠

2 ♠

*South*

Pass

You open in third seat and the bidding continues as shown.

Partner has a limit raise in ♠s and wonders if you have a full strength opening bid. Since you opened light you just return to ♠s at the minimum level.

Partner passes.

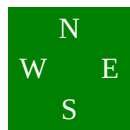
**Board 3**

North Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 6 4  
 ♥ 10 7 5  
 ♦ A 4 2  
 ♣ A K 10 8 6

♠ Q J 10 7  
 ♥ A 4  
 ♦ K 10 9 5 3  
 ♣ 9 4



♠ 8 3  
 ♥ Q J 9 6 2  
 ♦ 8 7 6  
 ♣ Q J 3

♠ A K 9 5 2  
 ♥ K 8 3  
 ♦ Q J  
 ♣ 7 5 2

| <i>West</i>  | <i>North</i> | <i>East</i> | <i>South</i> |
|--------------|--------------|-------------|--------------|
|              | Pass         | Pass        | 1 ♠          |
| Pass         | 2 ♣          | Pass        | 2 ♦          |
| Pass         | 4 ♠          |             |              |
| All Pass     |              |             |              |
| 4 ♠ by South |              |             |              |
| Lead: ♣K     |              |             |              |

Bold bidders might have opened with this hand, so when partner opens in third seat you naturally want to show your strength. If you play Reverse Drury there is only one way to do that, so you bid 2 ♣.

Partner rebids 2 ♦. What do you say next?

The 2 ♦ rebid shows a hand that partner would have opened in any position. So here it gets a little ambiguous. Surely a jump to 3 ♠ would be forcing, but to keep the possibility of misunderstandings low a jump to 4 ♠ is no doubt safer. After all, you can revalue your hand up to 13 points in support of ♠s.

**Board 4**

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ 7 5 2  
 ♥ K Q 10 6 3  
 ♦ Q J 9  
 ♣ A 7

♠ K J 8 6  
 ♥ 8 2  
 ♦ A 7 6 5  
 ♣ K 9 5



♠ A 9 4  
 ♥ A J 7  
 ♦ K 10 8 3  
 ♣ 10 8 2

♠ Q 10 3  
 ♥ 9 5 4  
 ♦ 4 2  
 ♣ Q J 6 4 3

| <i>West</i> | <i>North</i> | <i>East</i> | <i>South</i> |
|-------------|--------------|-------------|--------------|
|             |              | Pass        | Pass         |
| 1 ♥         | Pass         | 2 ♣         | Pass         |
| 2 ♦         | Pass         | 3 ♥         | Pass         |
| 4 ♥         |              |             |              |
| All Pass    |              |             |              |
| 4 ♥ by West |              |             |              |
| Lead: ♥ 2   |              |             |              |

You open in third seat and the bidding continues as shown.

Partner has a limit raise in ♥s and wonders if you have a full strength opening bid. Your 13 point hand qualifies as a decent opening bid, but certainly not enough extra to just jump to game. You bid 2 ♦, confirming the legitimate opener. Partner jumps to 3 ♥.

Partner shows a maximum limit-raise with his jump, so you bid the game.

**Board 5**

South Deals

None Vul

♠ K 9 6 5 2

♥ 7

♦ K Q 6

♣ Q 10 9 6

♠ Q 8 4

♥ A K J 5 3

♦ 8 2

♣ A 7 4



♠ A J 10 3

♥ 10 2

♦ A J 9 5

♣ J 5 2

♠ 7

♥ Q 9 8 6 4

♦ 10 7 4 3

♣ K 8 3

You like partner's ♥ suit but you have very little defensive strength. This is a good hand to preempt the bidding, trying to keep them from finding a ♠ fit.

So you jump to 3♥. Partner realizes you don't have any strength since you did not invoke Reverse Drury. He passes and you have bought the contract. It appears that their side might be able to make 4♠.

*West**North**East**South*

Pass

1♥

Pass

3♥

All Pass

3♥ by North

Lead: ♥10



**Board 6**

West Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 10 6 4 2

♥ K Q 5

♦ 8 6

♣ A Q 9 3

♠ K 3

♥ J 10 8 6 3

♦ 10 7 4

♣ K J 2



♠ Q J 9 8 7 5

♥ A 4

♦ K Q J

♣ 8 7

♠ A

♥ 9 7 2

♦ A 9 5 3 2

♣ 10 6 5 4

*West*

Pass

2 ♣

All Pass

4 ♠ by East

Lead: ♥ 2

*North*

Pass

Pass

*East*

1 ♠

4 ♠

*South*

Pass

You open in third seat and the bidding continues as shown.

Partner has a limit raise in ♠s and wonders if you have a full strength opening bid. Your 15 point hand is enough to insist on game, but opposite a passed hand you have no interest in a slam.

So you sign-off at 4 ♠.